Still the Great Naturalist in Dixon, I read everything I could about birds and wildlife of the Rock River Valley. My mother gave me a book, *Northern Lights*, that was based on the lives of the great white wolves of the north and I read it like a textbook, over and over, imagining myself with the wolves in the wild. She had a book containing Robert W. Service's ballad, "The Shooting of Dan McGrew." I reread it so many times that years later, on the occasional nights when I had trouble falling asleep, I'd remember every word and recite it silently to myself until I bore myself into slumber. If I still couldn't sleep, I'd switch to "The Cremation of Sam McGee," and that usually did it.

I'm sure that the fact our family moved so often left a mark on me.

Although I always had lots of playmates, during those first years in Dixon I was a little introverted and probably a little slow in making really close friends. In some ways I think this reluctance to get close to people never left me completely. I've never had trouble making friends, but I've been inclined to hold back a little of myself, reserving it for myself. As I'd done in the attic in Galesburg, I found a lot of enjoyment during those first years in Dixon in solitary ways—reading, studying wildlife, and exploring the local wilderness. I liked to draw cartoons and caricatures, and for a while fancied myself earning a living as an artist. I was a voracious reader and once I found a fictional hero I liked, I would consume everything I could about him. After reading one *Rover Boys* book, for example, I wouldn't stop until I'd finished all of them. It was the same thing with *Tarzan* and *Frank Merriwell at Yale*. (I also read *Brown of Harvard* but didn't like the hero as well as Merriwell, and for years that made me a little biased against Harvard.)

The books about college life, with exciting stories about Ivy League life and gridiron rivalries, planted in me the first